

GMUNC XII

American

Revolution

British Parliament

Dolly Wu • Head Chair
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About Chairs

Dolly Wu · Head Chair

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Dolly is a senior at Gunn High School and is honored to serve as your Head Chair this year! She has been participating in MUN for five years and has previously been Co-Chair for GMUNC XI and crisis staff for GMUNC X. Outside of MUN, Dolly is a varsity debater and the president of Philosophy Club. She is passionate about foreign policy, domestic politics, sociology, ethics, and advocacy. Less formally, she also enjoys pretty much all genres of music, mysteries (hats off for Conan Doyle), and watching competitive figure skating.

Melody Na · Co-Chair

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Melody is a junior at Gunn High School and is looking forward to co-chairing this committee for GMUNC XII. She has been involved in Model United Nations as a delegate since 8th grade, and this is her second year at GMUNC. Her passion for international relations has deepened as she has lived in four different countries and has experienced the significance of communication and relationships between various nations. She has attended multiple conferences, including GMUNC XI and NHSMUN, and hopes to learn more about MUN from a different perspective besides being a delegate. Melody is excited for the opportunity to co-chair for the first time and encounter various creative ideas during the debate.

About Committee

The British Parliament serves as the central legislative body of Great Britain, responsible for debating and enacting policies, overseeing government functions, and representing the interests of the British people. In other words, it shapes the nation's domestic and foreign affairs on both political and ideological levels. Parliament is divided into two houses—the House of Commons and the House of Lords—each playing a distinct role in Britain's legislative process. In this committee, however, the primary focus will be on the House of Commons. Delegates will step into the shoes of 18th-century British statesmen and political figures, navigating through one of the most consequential periods in the Empire's history, beginning with the passage of the Sugar Act in 1764.

Important Dates

Oct 4, 2024 - Research award deadline

Oct 10, 2024 - Final position paper deadline

Oct 11, 2024 - Day of conference

Committee Email

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Foreword

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the British Parliament! Please read this letter carefully, as it contains crucial information to ensure a smooth and enjoyable committee experience.

In this committee, amidst the growing chaos in our American colonies, we will discuss policies and actions aimed at addressing the growing unrest and challenges in our American territories. Our goal is to propose effective strategies to maintain order, safeguard British economic interests both at home and abroad, strengthen imperial governance, and ultimately preserve the unity and prosperity of the British Empire. Since this is a crisis committee, crisis updates will occur, and all writing will be done in the form of crisis notes and directives.

Position papers are due on October 4 to be considered for a research award, with the final deadline on October 10. Delegates who do not submit a position paper by the 10th will not be eligible for any committee awards. Please send all position papers and committee-specific inquiries to our committee email: parli.gmuncxii@gmail.com. Additionally, all delegates are required to complete the contact and medical forms to participate in the conference. Please confirm with your delegation that these documents have been submitted.

GMUNC welcomes delegates of all skill levels and will provide a review of standard parliamentary procedures at the beginning of the committee. We urge you to actively contribute to the committee and collaborate with other delegates. This conference may also be the first MUN conference for some delegates, so please act with courtesy.

We encourage you to thoroughly research your delegation's stance, come prepared with policy proposals, and be ready to compromise and adapt in the face of the unexpected. But most importantly, we hope you have a fun and engaging experience! If you have questions regarding how to write your position paper, conference information, or any general questions, please do not hesitate to reach out to us. We wish you the best with your research and look forward to seeing everyone on October 11, 2025 for GMUNC XII!

Sincerely,

Dolly Wu

Melody Na



Introduction

The American Revolution was a political and military conflict in the late 18th century that led to the thirteen colonies in North America declaring independence from Great Britain and, ultimately, establishing the United States of America.

In essence, the revolution centered around the question of sovereignty: who had the right to legislate for the colonies, and under what terms? Is the theory of "virtual representation" truly a just way to govern?

The British government believed firmly in Parliament's authority to govern and tax all parts of the Empire, while a growing number of colonial leaders began to assert that this authority is undermined by the lack of colonial representation in Parliament.

Tensions grew over time as political resistance and other acts of defiance in the colonies were met with crackdowns from London.

Eventually, these tensions gave way to armed conflict. The revolution was not only a war fought on battlefields, but also an ideological and political crisis that forced Britain to reevaluate its imperial structure and beliefs. For the Parliament, the American Revolution posed an unprecedented challenge that would shape the future of the British Empire for generations.



Historical Context

The conclusion of the Seven Years' War (1754-1763), also known as the French and Indian War, marked a turning point in global power dynamics and significantly altered the British Empire's strategic and financial priorities. The conflict, fought primarily between Great Britain and France, began in North America between colonial forces, with Native American support for both sides, before eventually expanding to multiple continents. The 1763 Treaty of Paris ended the war with a British victory, securing vast territorial gains for the Empire in North America, including Canada and lands east of the Mississippi River. This victory, however, came at a considerable cost: the war had nearly doubled Britain's national debt, placing enormous strain on the Crown's finances and sparking urgent debate over how to recover economically in an efficient and speedy manner. In addition to economic recovery, Parliament also had to grapple with the pressing issue of managing its newly acquired territories.

To address the latter, King George III issued the Proclamation of 1763, which prohibited colonial settlement to the west of the Appalachian Mountains. This measure was designed to prevent further conflicts with Indigenous groups and stabilise the region at a time when the colonists were eager to migrate westward to settle on more land. Ultimately, though, the proclamation proved to be largely ineffective in both reducing conflict between the colonies and Indigenous

communities and in preventing western settlement.

Economic recovery warranted more debate. In the 18th century, Britain operated under a mercantilist system, the dominant economic system in Europe at the time. Mercantilism was grounded in the belief that a nation's strength depended on its wealth, which is measured in gold and silver. The second premise is that the global amount of wealth was finite. Under this view, the goal of economic policy was to maximise exports, minimise imports, and maintain a favourable balance of trade. Colonies were vital to this system, serving both as sources of raw materials and as markets for finished goods produced in the mother country.

The economic pressure of post-war recovery, however, combined with political competition within Parliament, led to some economic reforms in Britain, especially regarding taxation and administrative policies. One of these changes was the dynamic between the Empire and its American colonies. There was growing consensus in Parliament that the era of relatively relaxed colonial oversight, often referred to as "salutary neglect", was no longer sustainable. Furthermore, many believed that the war had largely been fought for the benefit of the American colonies, thus making it a duty for those colonies to bear a portion of the war costs. As a result, Parliament sought to strengthen its authority

over the colonies by reinforcing trade laws and introducing new revenue-generating measures, the most prominent of which being taxation.

Thus, in 1764, Parliament passed the Sugar Act.

It is crucial here to re-emphasise that these initiatives were not initially implemented as

punitive measures, but rather out of logistical necessity. The American colonists, however, had their own reactions regardless of the intent. In response, Parliament took action accordingly.



Current Situation

The year is 1764. Parliament has just passed the Sugar Act as the first measure in a broader strategy to assert greater control over colonial administration and raise revenue from North America. The Act reduces the previous tax on molasses but enforces it more strictly. Additionally, it introduces stricter enforcement measures, undermining smuggling in the colonies and compromising general colonial economic autonomy.

Tensions are beginning to stir in North America. While the colonies remain loyal in name and do not want to fight their mother country, their growing resistance to imperial oversight is concerning. Murmurs of protest have begun in Massachusetts, and pamphlets questioning Parliament's authority are circulating among political and intellectual elites. Colonial assemblies are also starting to view these policies as violations of their fundamental rights as Englishmen.

Within the halls of Westminster, Parliament is at a crossroads. Some factions call for further taxation to meet financial needs and test colonial loyalty while others advocate for compromise to preserve long-term unity.

As members of the House of Commons, you now face a turning point in imperial policy. How will you respond? History has its eyes on you.

Goals for Committee

- Determine appropriate responses to colonial unrest.
- Propose fiscal strategies to address imperial debt.
- Define Parliament's stance on representation and sovereignty.
- Balance national interests with colonial governance and control.
- Prepare for future colonial escalation or compromise.
- Anticipate potential intervention by rival powers.
- Preserve the long-term stability and influence of the British Empire.

Questions to Consider

- What policy options are most effective in asserting Parliamentary authority over the American colonies without inciting full-scale rebellion?
- Should the British government pursue further taxation and economic control, or pivot to diplomatic reconciliation with colonial leaders?
- How can Parliament maintain control over the colonies while attempting to ease the national debt?
- Is military intervention a justified and sustainable solution to colonial unrest at this stage?

Committee Membership

Party	Parliamentary borough/county	Member of Parliament
Tory	Amersham	William Drake, Jr.
	Banbury	Frederick North, Lord North
	Dunbartonshire	Sir Archibald Edmonstone, 1st Baronet
	Maldon	John Strutt
	Bedford	Samuel Whitbread
	Berkshire	Arthur Vansittart
	Tewkesbury	Sir William Codrington, Bt
	Abingdon	John Morton
	Bedfordshire	Robert Ongley
	Derbyshire	Godfrey Bagnall Clarke
	Colchester	Charles Gray
	Middlesex	George Cooke
Whig	Derbyshire	Lord George Cavendish
	Peterborough	Matthew Wyldbore
	Castle Rising	Thomas Whately
	Durham	William Henry Lambton
	Stirling Burghs	James Masterton
	Tavistock	Richard Rigby
	Abingdon	Edward Loveden Loveden
	St Germans	John Peachey
	Appleby	William Pitt the Younger
	Aberdeen Burghs	Thomas Lyon
	Anglesey	Owen Meyrick
	Aldborough	Andrew Wilkinson
	Cambridge University	Thomas Townshend

	Colchester	Christopher Potter
Grenvillite	Buckingham	Richard Grenville
	Buckingham	James Grenville
	Buckinghamshire	Thomas Grenville
	Buckinghamshire	George Grenville

Appendix

American Revolution timeline (for reference only—committee may not follow this timeline):

- **1754–1763:** Seven Years' War/French and Indian War
- **1763:** Treaty of Paris ends the war
- **1763:** Proclamation of 1763
- **1764:** Sugar Act
- **1765:** Stamp Act
- **1766:** Stamp Act repealed; Declaratory Act passed
- **1767:** Townshend Acts
- **1770:** Boston Massacre
- **1773:** Tea Act
- **1773:** Boston Tea Party
- **1774:** Intolerable Acts
- **1774:** First Continental Congress
- **1775:** Battles of Lexington and Concord
- **1775:** Second Continental Congress
- **1775:** Battle of Bunker Hill
- **1776:** Common Sense by Thomas Paine published
- **1776:** Declaration of Independence adopted
- **1777:** Battle of Saratoga
- **1778:** France enters the war as an American ally
- **1781:** Battle of Yorktown
- **1783:** Treaty of Paris officially ends the war

British military overview (start of American Revolution):

- Army:

- On paper: ~48,600 regulars (39,300 infantry; 6,900 cavalry; 2,500 artillery)
- Deployed in North America: ~8,580 troops
- Peak strength in America: ~22,000 British troops + ~25,000 Loyalists + ~30,000 Hessian auxiliaries
- Naval:
 - Personnel (separate from army): ~16,000 seamen and marines
 - Ships: ~270 ships (including ~131 ships-of-the-line)
 - Ship types: First-rate (100+ guns), second-rate (90–100), third-rate (64–80), frigates, sloops
- Artillery:
 - Field guns: 3-, 6-, 12-, and 24-pounders; howitzers (8- to 13-inch); mortars (8- to 13-inch)
 - Siege guns: 18- and 24-pounders used in major engagements

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